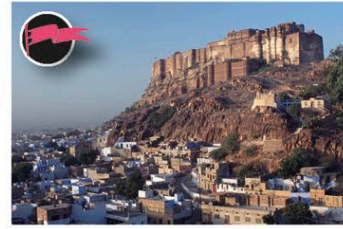


Asian castles

Castles in Asia reflect local building styles and look different than those in Europe, but they served the same purpose.



Himeji, Japan Built as a fort in 1333, Himeji was then rebuilt several times between the 14th and 17th centuries. It has 83 buildings protected by 85-ft- (26-m-) high walls and 3 moats, and is Japan's largest castle.



Mehrangarh Fort, India This fort, 400 ft (122 m) above the city of Jodhpur, hides several palaces within its walls. Built by the ruler Rao Jodha in 1459, it is entered through a series of seven gates.



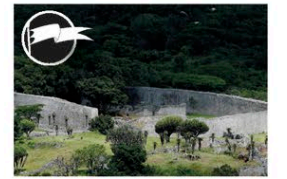
Fortified cities

Cities surrounded by defensive walls, often incorporating a castle or royal residence.



Forbidden City, China

The former imperial palace in Beijing has 980 buildings ringed by a wall and a 171-ft- (52-m-) wide moat.



Great Zimbabwe

Once the capital of the Kingdom of Zimbabwe, the stone walls of this royal city were built without using mortar.

WINDSOR CASTLE, ENGLAND, HAS BEEN A ROYAL RESIDENCE FOR 900 YEARS



Fort Independence, US This star-shaped fort, completed in 1851, defended the harbor of Boston. Guns were mounted on its five pointed bastions.



Castle of Good Hope, South Africa A star fort built by the Dutch East India Company in 1666-79 to protect Dutch settlers on the Cape of Good Hope.